Benjamin Throssell's

Ultimate Guide to The ONLY Diet System In The World That Actually Works.

A CRASH COURSE GUIDE

Get to know the only diet system that actually works — and a 'how-to' on making it work for you!



I'm Benjamin.

I'm a former fat boy that's lost a third of my weight and *kept it off.* And I'm a bit of a bleeding heart about helping other people feel their best and get in 'Hollywood' level shape.

I live in outback Australia, coach internationally, and write a free, slightly unhinged and *very* unfiltered daily newsletter on how to build your dream body, *fast.*

But this ain't about me.

It's about you, getting your head around the only diet system that works, and making it work for you.

Let's get into it.

CHAPTER N.1

Why ‘Tracking Your Macros’ Is The ONLY Diet System In The World That Actually Works

(...and what that means if you have NO clue what ‘macros’ are)



WANT MORE?
If you’re trying to get in shape, and want unhinged, unfiltered opinions on what works, what doesn’t, and more... click here.

If you're on a mission to be toned and sexy and totally finished building your dream body...

Well — I back ya.

But if you're not tracking your macros as you try to get there?

Then I still support you...

...I just also think you're an insane person 😇

Don't get your knickers twisted. Only the smallest bit of offence is intended when I say that.

But I'm standing my ground here:

There is only one diet system on the face of this planet that actually works.

It's called: tracking your macros.

And if you're doing anything other than tracking your macros to get in shape?

Then in almost every single conceivable scenario, you're crazy.

I did say 'almost', though.

Because there is a circumstance you could be in where I'll give you a pass. That is...

IF YOU DON'T KNOW WHAT THE HELL MACROS ACTUALLY ARE.

If I'm honest, I'd completely forgotten that was even a thing.

I've been pumping out body transformations for a long time. And for almost all of that time, I've been treating macros as assumed knowledge.

And maybe I've slipped into a fitness echo chamber and... kinda lost touch 🙃

But then, a few weeks back...

A pork sandwich *snapped* me back to reality.

I was having dinner (a bánh mì, if you must know) with a friend and reader of my daily emails.

Between bites of crunchy roast pork, mayo, herbs and pickled veg in a crispy roll, she asked a question.

Sweetly...

Innocently...

And without a clue that she was about to burst my 'everyone knows macros bubble', she said...

“So, I know what a calorie deficit is. But what exactly is that ‘macro’ thing you’re on about all the time?”

It was equal parts stunning and refreshing.

How could someone … NOT know what ‘macros’ were?

But of course, I quickly remembered that not everyone does this for a living, and that it really isn’t that shocking.

Anyway, I shared the story in my emails…

…and the next day, I woke up to a swathe of replies from other readers. All in various shades of the same situation — close to clueless as to what macros actually are, and what they do.

Well. I’ll be damned if I don’t do *something* to help fix this.

So, if you don’t know what macros are, I’ve got news.

I’m about to tell you about the last new diet you will ever need to try.

Let me get you up to speed and introduce what the whole ‘macros’ thing’s really all about.

Which, to put it plainly, is…

How to eat what you want, and get jacked doing it.

When you put it that way, it ain't hard to see the appeal of macro tracking as a nutrition approach.

We can get a little nerdier (and we will) but that sexy header up there?

That's about what macros boil down to (when you do them right).

But to properly understand them, we've gotta zoom out a little bit, and give you a bit more of a background.

Let me take you back to what my friend said to me that night at dinner:

"I've heard of a calorie deficit..."

Look — if this were a few weeks ago... I'd have kicked this off by saying we've probably all heard of a calorie deficit at this point.

And that might be true, but I would have said the same about macros, too 🤦

So let me play it safe and cover this first (because it's the foundation for understanding macros).

Ready?

A calorie deficit is the mechanism that drives ANY and EVERY fat loss diet in existence.

Real quick, so that I play it *safe* safe:

A calorie...

A unit of energy, the same way a centimetre's a unit of distance. A hundred centimetres makes a metre. A hundred calories is enough energy to heat a kilogram of ice to boiling point. Calories are just how we measure the energy your body burns to run.

A deficit...

Having less than you need.

(And yes, I was incredibly tempted to expand this definition to make these columns the same size. But I resisted the urge. You don't need to make everything perfec— ah, that's better.)

So a calorie deficit = eating less energy than your body needs to keep running — meaning you have to 'burn fat' to make up the difference.

(Also, if you're here and want to be bigger and stronger, hang with me. We'll get there.)

Okay, back to it now.

If you're losing fat using the diet you're eating, it's because you're eating in a deficit.

It's *not* because of the food.

It's *not* because you nailed the timing of your intermittent fasting.

It's *not* because you're getting in every superfood under the sun.

Rather...

It’s because whatever you’re consuming is less energy than your body’s burning.

Whether you eat less or more doesn’t really change the amount it takes to keep you alive, though.

If you eat less than the ‘staying alive’ number, your body’s gotta get that gap of energy from somewhere.

That ‘somewhere’ is your fat stores. Your ‘winter acorns’, so to speak, that your body stored up when you ate too much, to use for times like this.

So if you get that balance (or more accurately, imbalance) right...

Then no matter what you eat, you’ll lose weight.

So far, so good. I’m guessing you’re still with me at this point.

But it tends to be the case that when I get practical with this, some folks get confused.

For the sake of being crystal clear, that means:

→ You can eat McDonalds three meals a day, and if you’re under your staying-alive-number, you’ll LOSE weight.

→ You can eat chicken breast and spinach leaves for three meals a day, and if you're over your staying-alive-number, you'll GAIN weight.

If you've never heard that before, it might rattle your brain. Take a second and soak it in if so.

Also, since not everyone wants to be skinnier... if you're one of my doggies trying to build muscle? All we're doing is swinging that balance in the other direction.

If you eat more than what your body needs — and combine it with a well designed lifting plan?

Say 'hello' to muscles. Your body will put the majority of those extra calories toward getting bigger and more toned.

Alright. Foundation laid.

If that's how calories work...

Where do macros come in?

Glad you asked. Let's talk about it.

CHAPTER N.2

What in the hell are ‘macros’?

WANT MORE?
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Think of your daily calorie needs as the amount of fuel your body's engine needs to run.

Macros – short for macronutrients – are the type of fuel we put in.

There are three we've got to work with: protein, carbohydrate (carbs), and fat. (Well, four, if you count booze.)

Each of 'em are unique. They all do something different, but all of them give you energy to help you hit your daily calories.

Protein



Protein is for **muscle.**

It's for other stuff too, like hair and skin and nails, or healing injuries.

And it’s what helps you grow muscle to build a toned, healthy body if you’re finished losing fat.

Protein is made up of what we as humans are made up of. Think of it like this:

Protein is to the body what a brick is to a building.

And remember, as one of our macros, it’s a source of our daily energy.

It isn’t the best form to give us a quick boost, but per gram, it gives us four calories worth of energy.

But as the macro that helps us repair and grow our bodies? No matter what your goal is, getting enough protein is absolutely essential.

The perfect amount to eat varies a little, but aiming to eat 1.5—2g per kilogram of your bodyweight is a good place to be.

Fat

Fat is for **health**. Weird, right? Doesn’t really match up with what we’ve heard...

That, and the ‘health’ angle might also sound a little snooze if you’re dead set on getting sexier. But *good luck* getting sexier if you’re sick all the time.

Anyway, like I was saying: fat gets a bad rap. And unfairly so.

First, because when you’ve let yourself go a little, you don’t say you’re feeling a little protein — you say you’re feeling fat 🤣

That's accurate: **saving energy as fat is how the body likes to put away those 'winter acorns' we spoke about earlier.**

Since they're what makes us feel a little fluffy, jiggly and unsexy… we're kinda geared to be off fats from the start.

Advertising leans into that by stamping products with "Low Fat!" and "99% Fat Free!". And because it's pitched as a benefit, we get sucked harder into hating fat.



The second reason is this: fat has more than double the energy of protein and carbs by weight, coming in at nine calories per gram.

I can see where the hangup comes from. It's a lot easier to get too much energy in through fat if you're not careful.

But just stamping it as 'bad' is a little daft.

To me, that feels like saying gold's bad because it's more dense than aluminium.

That's the wrong perspective, and we're just using the wrong measuring stick.

Sure, you've got to keep in mind that it's easy to overdo it with fat, but you also can not live without it.

It regulates your hormones. It allows you to absorb nutrients that make your body run right. It keeps your sex drive steady, and keeps your immune system chugging along.

In short: you'll be six feet under without it (seriously). And it makes food tasty. Which is equally important.

As for how much you need?

Anywhere between 0.5-1.5g per kilogram of your bodyweight is right. Where you land in that range depends on your goals, and how you like to eat.

Carbohydrate

Carbohydrate is for **energy.**

And for pasta. And pastries. And pretty much all the delicious stuff in life.

People give carbs a hard time – especially for fat loss – but they're wrong. Carbs are *phenomenal* for you.

These are the best macro for a quick energy boost, and they're your body's favourite fuel source to turn to.

Carbs are great for fuelling workouts so you can train hard, and they're brilliant for recovery.

Your brain needs them too, and when you're feeling hangry you're almost definitely short on carbs.

The same as protein, you get four calories per gram of carb you eat. But as great as they are, carbs are not essential for you to eat.

You'll feel garbage without them, but you'll survive. As such, there isn't a fixed



target you have to hit, and it depends on your goal.

But to give you an idea: I eat as many of them as I can fit in my diet. Don't let the "carbs are bad for you!" twerps trick ya.

Alright, let's recap. Now you know:

→ What a 'calorie' actually is

→ That all diets work not by how healthy your food is, or when you eat it. They work by controlling how many calories you eat (less than you need to drop fat, and more than you need to build muscle)

→ That your macros are where you get your calories (or energy) from, and that you need a certain amount of each for a successful, balanced diet

So with all that said...

WHAT ARE YOU MEANT TO *DO* WITH THAT INFORMATION?

Well, now you'll have to decide if you want to use it.

You can keep eating the way you're eating if you want. Or, you can start another 'diet'. Or, you can start tracking your macros 😇

You can calculate how much of each macro you'll personally need for your goals (there are calculators for this, and they're easy to find online).

And then you can start using a tracking app to find out how much of each macro you're hitting in your diet.

Foods *contain* macronutrients like protein and fat.

A 100g portion of steak is not equal to 100g of protein — it'll be more like 25g of protein, and some fat. (The rest is stuff like water and fibre.)

I had a very panicked client tell me once, "I eat a 200g steak at dinner — I'm blowing over my target just with that!"

Don't fret. Not how it works.

And by tracking your food in an app you'll see what you're currently eating, and if it hits the targets you found out were perfect for your goal.

If you aren't, you can use that knowledge and adjust your

food to better fit your targets.

It can be finicky to start. But if you want great results out of your diet, you need to know whether you're hitting the right macros.

And you do that by tracking.

But, "Hang on," you might be saying...

"Not *all* diets use macro tracking. I didn't track my last diet, and I still made some gains?

That's true.

Not all diets do. Things like keto or carnivore or even the meal plan your trainer made you don't ask you to track calories.

The diet is just indirectly controlling them for you by telling you which foods you're allowed to eat.

It makes things simple — you don't need to track. You just eat what your plan says and your calories and macros get taken care of for you.

For as long as you can keep following it and saying 'no' to anything you used to like eating, you're golden.

But let's call a spade a spade here: it might be simple, but you're also totally in the dark.

Which is what brings us to...

CHAPTER N.3

The big, fat, inconvenient truth about conventional diets.

WANT MORE?
If you're trying to get in shape, and want unhinged, unfiltered opinions on what works, what doesn't, and more... click here.

Here’s the problem with conventional “dieting” in a nutshell.

Simply put:

You’re not eating YOUR diet.

And unless you plan on adopting someone else’s diet philosophy? Eating only the foods and portions they say you should? And never going back to having dinner with your family, or catching up with a friend for a pint?

Then at some point, you will have to stop.

And when you do, you’ll be back to square one, and **back in square one’s body.**

I’ll admit that the ‘diet’ approach makes things simple.

But you’re trading a hell of a lot for simple:

✦ Control over what you eat...

✦ How fun you find eating...

✦ How long you can really stick with it (and thus how long you get to stay in the shape you wanted)...

✦ How ‘normal’ your life feels...

✦ The freedom to catch up with friends over food, and to eat what they’re eating...

✦ And so on...

It’s a bad deal 🤣

But there is one thing that I can get behind. A reason that might drive a hot-body-hopeful to a restrictive diet in search of.

It’s something that I desperately wanted when I was trying to lose over 20kg. It was...

“I just want to know that what I’m doing is *actually working.*”

That reason alone might be enough to justify all the trade offs.

I’ll admit it – to know for a fact that my diet was working back then? And that I was making real, measurable steps toward my goal?

I would – did – trade all of those things for the ‘certainty’ it was meant to give me.

Sometimes it worked. And I got what I sacrificed for.

But sometimes it didn’t. And I got nowhere.

I was just eating some weird, miserable diet from someone else. Missing out on my real life and food I liked. And with nothing to show for it.

But there’s another way. You can bypass literally ALL of the BS that the conventional dieting method brings with it, by simply...

TRACKING YOUR DAMN MACROS.

You do that, and...

You can eat what you want.

You can catch up with your friends.

You can be flexible, instead of saying, “Sorry, I can’t. That’s not on my plan.”

You can build the body of your dreams and *keep it for good.*

All you need to do is get your head around how to...

Replace the ‘diet’ with what actually *works.*

And I’ll show you how 😇

It’s not something radical, either.

Remember, the ‘diet’ formula is this:

- The diet tells you what you’re allowed to eat...
- Which decides your calories and macros for you.

And IF they’re right for you...

- The diet *might* work.

And all we're really doing is taking you behind the curtain, and flipping that model on its head.

We start with a guaranteed assumption:

✦ The diet WILL work, because...

✦ YOU decide the calories and macro targets to make that happen...

✦ And YOU pick what you'll eat to hit them.

Same formula, *just flipped.*

If that looks like the same thing every day? Sweet.

If it means something different every day? Also sweet.

You do it however you like. And by adjusting your targets, you can speed things up or slow them down, and make gains on your schedule.

The cool part?

We're doing it all devoid of any overarching, dogmatic diet "philosophy".

It's as simple as calculating how much energy you need, and how much of each macro suits your goal.

It's so simple that it might seem...

...too good to be true!

It most certainly is not, though.

And I'll prove it.

Because now, we're up to getting practical. Strap in.

CHAPTER N.4

The practical, no B.S. guide on macros.

WANT MORE?
If you're trying to get in shape, and want unhinged, unfiltered opinions on what works, what doesn't, and more... click here.

I'll keep this as short, sweet and simple as I can, so you've only got the big rocks to think about...

Step one. Calculate your macros.

Use an online calculator and follow the prompts it gives you.

Once you've followed them, you'll end up with targets for calories, protein, fat and carbohydrate.

Step two. Download a tracking app.

Input the targets your calculator gave you, and track what you eat.

Make sure the foods you eat have you hitting your targets.

Track as accurately as you can, so you know you're hitting the targets right.

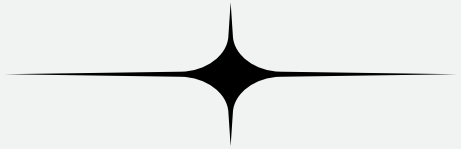
We don’t want you in the dark like diets have you. So if you have a clear and reliable record of what you eat, you’ll know exactly what’s happening.

Step three.
Track your results.

The results are what we’re here for 😎 so weigh yourself often.

Make sure your weight is moving in the right direction. And if it isn’t (and you’ve been tracking accurately), you know you’ve hit a red flag.

Instead of sticking things out and hoping for a change, you’ll know to adjust your targets ASAP to make things move again.



And that’s that.

Of course, it can go *a lot deeper.*

We can talk about which foods are better or worse, controlling how fast you get results (because yes, that’s completely up to YOU), what to do if things stop working, and all manner of other things.

But fundamentally, that's all there is to it.

And you're better off starting with the basics — making your boat float, before you worry about polishing the decks.

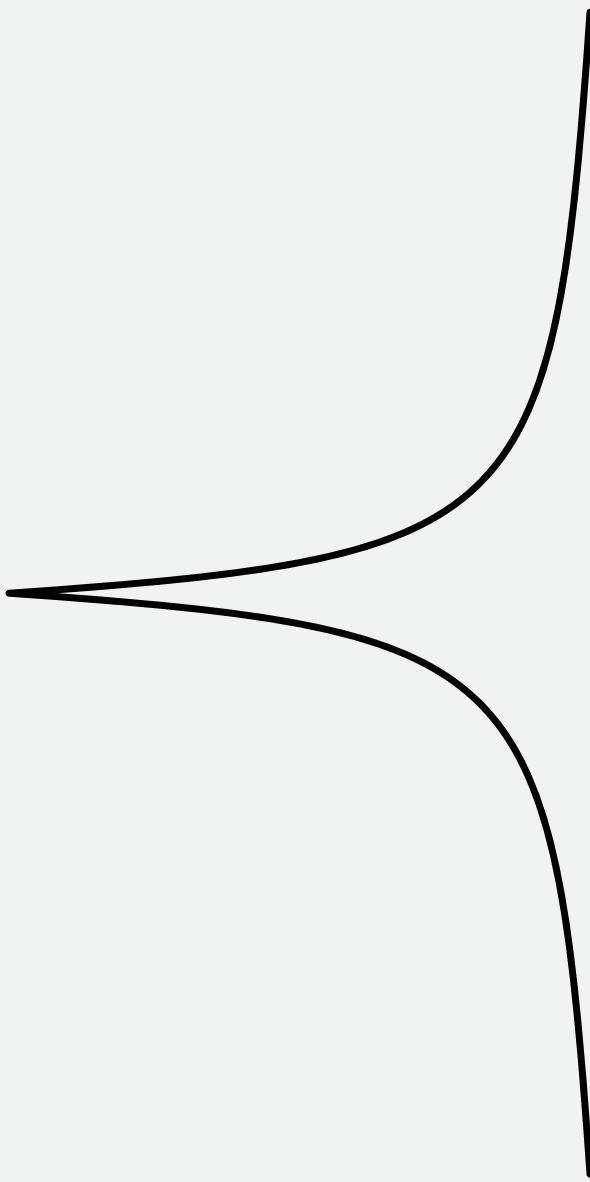
Like anything, there'll be a learning curve.

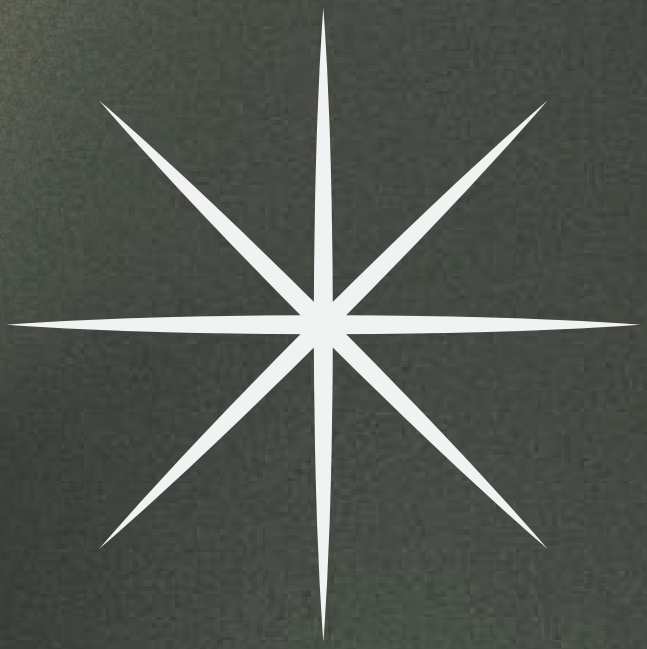
But macros are the ticket off the hamster wheel of fad diets and yo-yoing all over the place, if you can execute them right.

And for freedom, flexibility, and finally building (and keeping) the lean, toned body you've always wanted?

It's well worth the work.

BENJAMIN THROSSELL





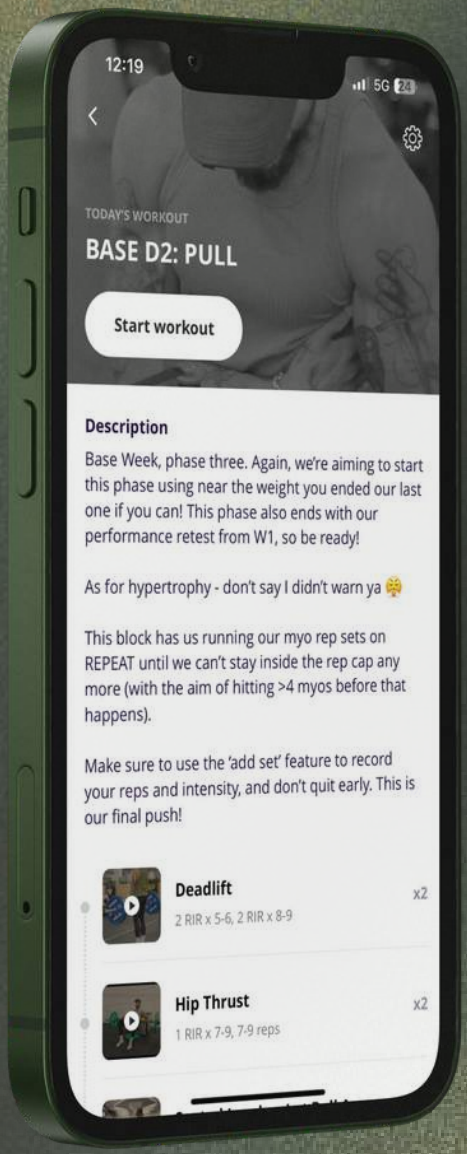
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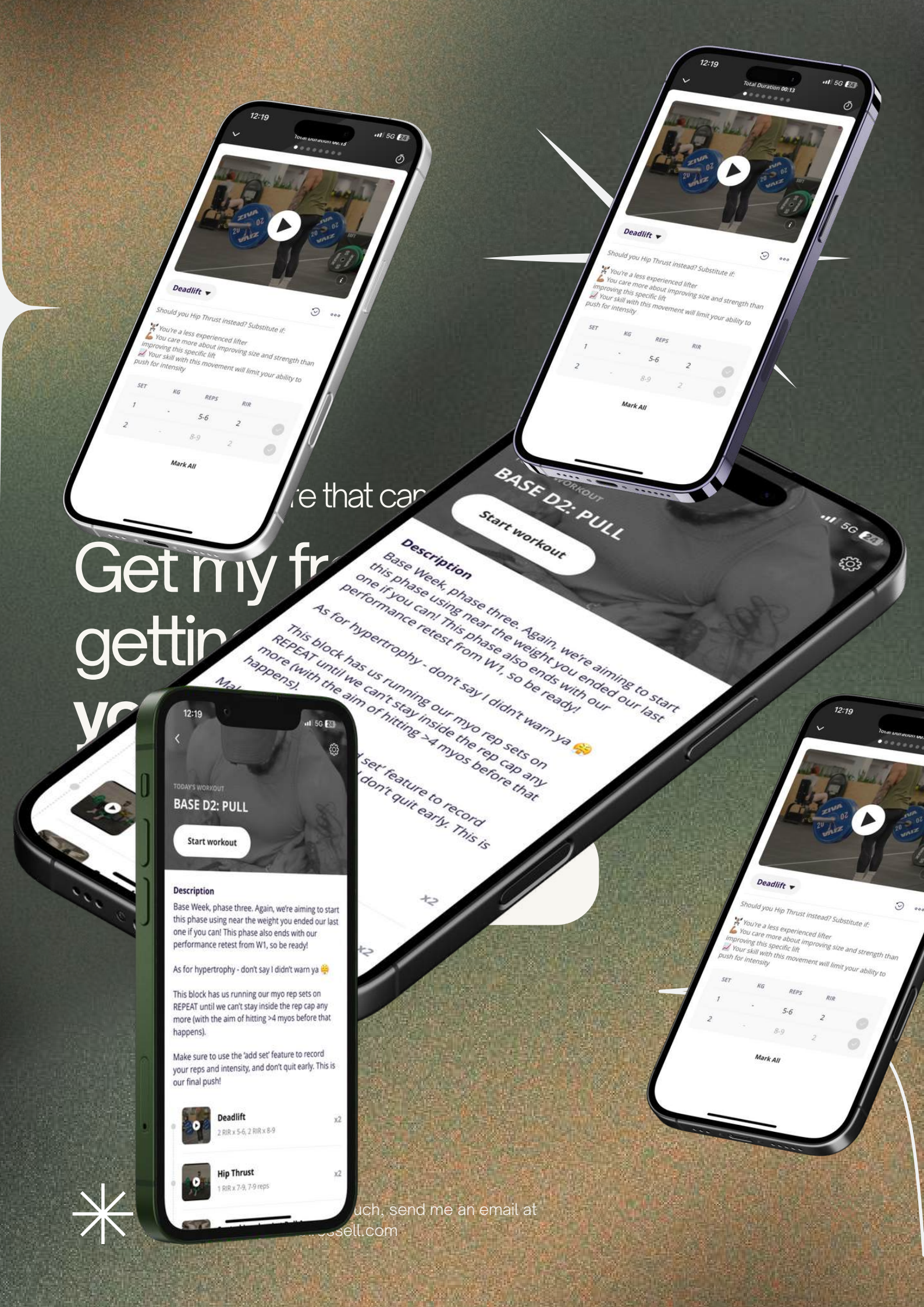


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